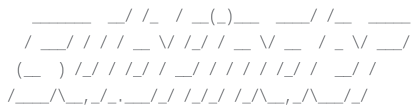


FOSS Security Tools:

Subfinder

The fourth article in the ongoing series on FOSS security tools introduces the subdomain discovery tool called subfinder.



Subfinder is optimised for speed and is easy to use on websites. Designed to use passive online sources to maximise the results, it includes wildcard elimination modules. You can produce the results to standard output, file or JSON formats. It is written using the Go programming language and released under the MIT licence.

We will use Go version 1.22.4 installed on Parabola GNU/Linux-libre (x86-64) for the subfinder examples.

Installation

The Parabola GNU/Linux-libre (x86-64) is a free, lightweight, Libre rolling-release distribution which is based on Arch Linux.

```
$ cat /etc/os-release
NAME=Parabola
PRETTY_NAME="Parabola GNU/Linux-libre"
ID=parabola
ID_LIKE=arch
BUILD_ID=rolling
VARIANT="x86_64 SystemD Edition"
VARIANT_ID="x86_64-systemd"
ANSI_COLOR="1;35"
HOME_URL="https://www.parabola.nu/"
DOCUMENTATION_URL="https://wiki.parabola.nu/"
SUPPORT_URL="ircs://irc.libera.chat/#parabola"
BUG_REPORT_URL="https://labs.parabola.nu/"
LOGO="parabola-logo"
```

You need to first install Go on the system using the 'pacman' package management tool as follows:

```
$ sudo pacman -S go
```

The GOPATH and PATH environment variables need to be set in ~/.bashrc.

```
GOPATH=$HOME/go
PATH=$PATH:$GOROOT/bin:$GOPATH/bin
```

You will then need to source the ~/.bashrc file for the settings to take effect:

```
$ source ~/.bashrc
```

You can verify the version of Go installed using the following command:

```
$ go version
go version go1.22.4 linux/amd64
```

You can now install subfinder using the "go" executable as shown below:

```
$ go install -v github.com/projectdiscovery/subfinder/v2/cmd/
subfinder@latest
go: downloading github.com/projectdiscovery/subfinder/v2 v2.6.6
go: downloading github.com/projectdiscovery/subfinder
v2.6.6+incompatible
go: downloading github.com/projectdiscovery/fdmax v0.0.4
...
github.com/projectdiscovery/utls/update
github.com/projectdiscovery/subfinder/v2/pkg/runner
github.com/projectdiscovery/subfinder/v2/cmd/subfinder
```

Docker

You can also use the subfinder Docker image instead of doing a local installation in order to use the tool. For example:

```
$ sudo docker pull projectdiscovery/subfinder:latest
```